

Tobias Treppmann

Design systems that hold when nobody is watching

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

The standard has to live in the build, because it cannot live in my review. At Bibel TV I own UI quality across iOS, Android, web and connected TV, with no design team and engineering at an external agency. The tokens ship as an API: three tiers, one commit reaching every platform. Six checks in CI refuse work that leaves the system, and over a library believed clean they found 32 off-system values. Design systems at Ninox and Datameer before that.

32

off-system values the build caught in a library believed clean after two cleanup passes

Six countries

accessibility delivered under EU regulation and church data-protection law

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Token architecture in three tiers — global primitives, then semantic, then component. Style Dictionary on DTCG, synced live to Figma and Android. One commit reaches every platform.
- A system the build enforces — six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI. Over a library believed clean they identified 32 off-system values.
- What those checks catch — a token reference that does not resolve, and a color hardcoded into a component. Both render, so review never sees them.
- A color engine in OKLCH — k-means clustering rather than RGB, so themes carry even perceptual weight. WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.
- Agentic engineering, introduced from zero — prototypes in real code against real production APIs.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Design-system governance as a working group — four designers and engineering, with an escalation path. Motion belonged to the system too, as custom easing curves.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product. Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Accessibility audited past our own front door — our website, and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.
- The standard had to hold in output made by parish staff — not by specialists. AI alt-text shipped for EU accessibility compliance across six countries.
- The architecture call I defended through the build — the internal plan was a standalone add-on module. I delivered an embedded platform capability instead. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Component behavior and specs across the library — I defined how components behaved and what they promised, and the UI designers executed the visual system.
- Five years of data-dense enterprise interfaces — pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, filter logic. A functional head trading scope with product and engineering counterparts.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with a listed group's executive team to productize its service organization. Ran design-thinking training for leadership and for the service teams.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

Member, Mentor Advisory Board · *The UX School* · 2017 – 2018 · Remote

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

SKILLS

Design Systems and Token Architecture

DTCG tokens in three tiers with Style Dictionary, synced live to Figma and Android · One commit propagates to every platform · Storybook as the source of truth, with a prototyping layer on top · Shared governance across four designers and engineering at Ninox, with an escalation path · Component behavior and specs across the Datameer library

Tools, Governance and Workflows

Six checks that run identically on a laptop and in CI and refuse off-system work · 32 off-system values identified in a library believed clean · The system reports its own token gaps, eight so far, in the order people hit them · New technologies integrated into the workflow rather than trialled beside it

Accessibility and Inclusive Design

At ChurchDesk we audited our own website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance · Screen-reader semantics and ARIA as standing practice at Bibel TV, ChurchDesk and Ninox · AI alt-text shipped for EU accessibility compliance across six countries · WCAG contrast validated inside the color engine, in light and dark

Interaction, Visual and Systems Design

A color engine live in production, k-means clustering in OKLCH rather than RGB · Every threshold a dial in the config tool rather than a commit · Selah — Mindful Transitions, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store · Prototypes in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools; Android/Kotlin, SwiftUI, React and web

Strategy, Influence and Change

Senior Leadership Team at Ninox, where design strategy was aligned to business and product goals rather than argued for afterwards · Strategic thinking that starts from what the business is trying to do and works back to the system · The Bibel TV standard is enforced by the build and holds across a handoff to an external engineering agency · Ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, two at the Interaction Design Foundation · Stakeholder relationships managed and harmonized across Spreadshirt's matrix organization of 200-plus people · Service-to-product transformation with Hypoport's executive team